



LISTENING

#13

1 - Visiting the hair salon or barbershop is a common everyday situation. In this class, you will listen to a conversation between a customer and a hairdresser. Pay attention to how they greet each other, how the customer explains what he wants, and how the hairdresser responds.

Getting a Haircut

1 - How did the customer greet the hairdresser?

2 - Instead of asking "What kind of cut are you thinking?" what are some other ways the hairdresser could ask about the haircut?

3 - What did the customer mean when he asked if the hairdresser could fit him in that day?

4 - What procedures can be done at the hair salon for men and for women that you can remember?

5 - How exactly did the customer want his haircut?

6 - Did the customer choose clippers or scissors?

7 - Was there any special occasion coming up for the customer, or was it just a regular haircut?

8 - What did the hairdresser mean by "I've seen worse"?

9 - True or False: The customer requested to have the sides a bit longer than the top of his head.

10 - Do you think if someone is only getting a trim, it is better to do it at home and save money, or is it still important to go to the barbershop or salon?

10 Rules for Better Haircuts

We have all experienced a bad haircut at some point: too short, too high-maintenance, or simply unflattering. It is not always the barber's fault. Often, success depends on preparation, communication, and self-awareness before sitting in the chair. The article outlines 10 practical rules for better haircuts.

1. Start with your face shape – The haircut should balance and harmonize facial proportions. Round, square, and long faces require different approaches.
2. Use celebrity references wisely – Photos can inspire, but each person has unique texture, density, and hairline, so expectations must be realistic.
3. Ask for modifications – Instead of demanding an identical cut, consult the barber to adapt styles to your features.
4. Think about styling needs – Some cuts require new products or routines. Creams, pomades, and pastes can suit different occasions.
5. Factor in facial hair – Haircuts should complement beards or mustaches. Sometimes the clash comes from facial hair, not the cut.
6. Upgrade your hair care routine – Healthy, conditioned hair cooperates better with styling and cuts. Proper products make a big difference.
7. Choose the right barbershop – Professionals have specialties: barbers excel in shorter styles, while stylists handle longer, more detailed looks.
8. Consider aging and hair loss – Thinning hair may call for new styles or even embracing buzz cuts and shaved heads.
9. Be careful with trends – Fads like mullets or undercuts might not suit everyone. Wait, observe, and adapt before jumping in.
10. Have a reset plan – If a cut fails, know your backup styles: buzz cut, crew cut, or even experimenting with bold colors.

Conclusion: A good haircut depends on knowing yourself, communicating clearly with your barber, maintaining healthy hair, and making conscious choices between trends and timeless styles.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1. Why does the article suggest that a bad haircut is not always the barber's fault?

2. What is the importance of considering face shape when choosing a haircut?

3. How should customers use celebrity photos when asking for a haircut?

4. Why does the article recommend upgrading one's hair care routine?

5. What is the purpose of having a "reset plan" for haircuts?
